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Ankush Panghal



Men's 80kg

Eight years ago, Ankush Panghal was ready to walk away from boxing. Then just 14 years old, he had lost the final of his first state championship and was so disheartened that he decided he had had enough. It took his father's persuasion to make him persist. "Defeats are temporary," father Suresh Panghal told him then.

On August 1, that choice would prove to be the right one, with the 22-year-old from Bherian village in Hisar pulling off the biggest victory of his career, beating England's Dimeji Shittu to win the 80kg gold at the Commonwealth Games.

It's a win that's the high point of a journey that began for Ankush when he was 11 years old.

He had no big dreams back then and had only taken up the sport because that was what his elder siblings were also training in. Those early days were hardly glamorous. He



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started at a government school in Gangwa village, where facilities were limited and there was no proper boxing ring. Coach Pradeep Sawant nevertheless saw something in him: an eagerness to learn and an ability to pick up techniques quickly.

Ankush's father drove almost 15km each day to get him to training, overruling those who felt the youngster was too slight for boxing. And when his son suffered defeat at the state championships, it was his father

once again who pushed him to continue.

Ankush eventually began fulfilling the promise his coaches had seen. He'd go on to win the national school title at 14 before progressing through junior and senior international competition.

In Glasgow, his counter-attacking style and trademark right straight and left hook carried him through the tournament. He beat Canada's Joshua Ofori 5-0 in the semifinal before setting up a clash with England's top hope Shittu in the final. It was a hard-fought win. Ankush lost the first round unanimously and was even given a standing eight count. But just like when he was 14, he got back up from that early setback and would go on to win the next two and seal his place in Indian boxing legend.



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Sachin Siwach



Men's 60kg

For five years, Sachin Siwach seemed to be accumulating more frustration than medals. Injuries, questionable verdicts and bad luck stalled a boxer who had already shown his pedigree by becoming a World Youth champion in 2021 — incidentally becoming the second boxer named

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Sachin Siwach from the village of Mitathal in Haryana to do so. At the Asian Games, World Championships and Olympic qualifiers, however, he could not make the breakthrough he wanted.

This year he started showing glimpses of his class once again when he

took silver at the Asian Championships. And he's made a powerful statement of his quality at the Glasgow Games. The 60kg boxer beat opponents from Canada, England, Botswana and Wales before a perfect last-second punch saw him pull off a remarkable come-from-behind victory over Namibia's Tryagain Morning Ndevelo in the final to win Commonwealth Games gold.

There was a particularly important figure in that journey. From 2023 to 2025, Sachin shared a room and training space with former world No. 1, world silver medallist and 2022 Commonwealth Games champion Amit Panghal. Panghal, Sachin says, helped him understand the less obvious parts of elite boxing — diet, recovery, movement, defence and how to identify his own strengths and weaknesses.

Now the Commonwealth title has given him something he had been missing — self-belief. His next target is the Asian Games, where he wants to erase the memory of a quarterfinal exit at the previous edition. "It was just luck. This Asiad will be different," he says.